



STORIES FOR TOMORROW

17 Fairy Tales for the 17 Sustainable Development Goals



ELYX ON THE ROADS
KA210-SCH - Small-scale partnerships in school education
Project No. 2024-1-PL01-KA210-SCH-000247614
Erasmus+ • EOTR

PREFACE

Stories for Tomorrow

Dear children, teachers, parents and readers,

This book was born from a simple but important idea: the future belongs to everyone, and children should have the opportunity to imagine it before they begin to build it.

The seventeen Sustainable Development Goals of the United Nations speak about poverty, hunger, health, education, equality, peace, the environment, climate, our oceans and our planet. These may sound like very big subjects. Yet the future of all these things will also depend on the choices that today's children will make tomorrow.

That is why we have chosen to speak about the Sustainable Development Goals through fairy tales.

Children understand the world not only through facts and explanations, but also through imagination, emotions, characters and stories. A story can transform a difficult idea into an adventure, a problem into a challenge, and a solution into something that a child can understand and remember.

In these pages, the Sustainable Development Goals become journeys. There are forests to protect, communities to help, rivers to save, bridges to build and differences to overcome. The characters may be small, but their choices can make a great difference.

We wanted this book to encourage children to ask questions:

What can I do?

How can I help?

What would I change?

What kind of world would I like to live in?

The purpose is not to give children all the answers. It is to give them the courage to imagine better answers for themselves.

This is also why this book looks towards the future. Sustainability is not only about protecting what we have today; it is about taking responsibility for the world we will leave to those who come after us. Education has a fundamental role in this process. By developing curiosity, creativity, empathy, critical thinking and a sense of responsibility, we can help children become active citizens rather than simply spectators of the future.

Stories for Tomorrow is therefore more than a collection of fairy tales. It is an invitation to dream, to think and, eventually, to act.

May these stories inspire children to believe that even the smallest person can make a difference, that cooperation is stronger than division, and that a better future begins with the imagination of what is possible.

The future has not been written yet.

Let us give our children the chance to write it.

Gianfranco Pistone

ABOUT THE PROJECT

ELYX ON THE ROADS

Project acronym: EOTR

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The Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) are 17 interconnected global goals adopted by United Nations Member States as part of the 2030 Agenda. They address poverty, hunger, health, education, equality, water, energy, work, innovation, inequalities, communities, responsible consumption, climate, oceans, life on land, peace and partnerships.

This book turns those large ideas into stories for children aged approximately 6–11. Each tale presents a challenge, invites the reader to notice different points of view, and ends with a hopeful idea about cooperation, responsibility or action.

The official goal names used in this book follow the United Nations 2030 Agenda.

Editorial note

This volume is an original editorial master edition created from the educational framework of the ELYX ON THE ROADS project. The project application states that, during the final activity in Latvia, selected tales written by students would be compiled into a book of 17 tales in English about the 17 UN Sustainable Development Goals. The stories in this master edition are therefore original model tales, not claims of student authorship. They can serve as a complete prototype and can later be replaced or enriched with the selected student tales.

Project partners named in the application: FUNDACJA TALE EURO EST (Poland); Guzeloba Ilkokulu (Türkiye); Malpils vidusskola (Latvia); 1o DIMOTIKO SXOLEIO ITEAS (Greece).

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The Village Where No One Was Left Behind



SDG 1 • No Poverty

The Village Where No One Was Left Behind

At the edge of a green valley stood a little village called Brightbrook. Every house had a blue door, except one: a small house at the end of Willow Lane whose door had lost its paint.

Mila lived there with her grandfather. They were not poor in kindness, but some days they did not have enough food, warm clothes, or money for the things other children took for granted.

One morning, ELYX appeared on the village noticeboard as a tiny glowing picture. "A village is strongest when everyone can take part," he said.

The mayor had planned a festival, but Mila asked, "What about people who cannot afford the festival?"

The question changed everything.

The children made a list of things the village already had. The baker could share bread at the end of each day. The carpenter could repair broken chairs. The farmer had extra vegetables. The library had books waiting to be read. The tailor had cloth left over from old projects.

Instead of giving one person a little and another person a lot, the villagers created a community cupboard and a skills table. Anyone could offer something, and anyone could ask for something.

Mila's grandfather repaired a broken clock. The carpenter taught him how to fix wooden toys. Mila helped the librarian organize books. Soon, people who had once felt invisible were teaching others what they knew.

At the festival, there were no special tables for "those who had" and "those who had not." There was one long table.

ELYX glowed above it.

"Poverty is not only about money," he said. "It can also mean being excluded from opportunities, safety, learning, or belonging."

Mila looked around the table. "Then the best treasure is making sure nobody is left behind."

And Brightbrook discovered that helping one another did not make the village smaller. It made everyone's world bigger.

From that day on, whenever a problem appeared, the villagers asked the same question first:

"Who might be missing from the table?"

And they always made room.

THINK & ACT

- Notice: What problem did the characters discover? Think: Which choice made the biggest difference? Act: What is one small thing your class or family could do?

A small question can become a big idea. A small action can become a habit.

The Seeds of the Generous Earth



SDG 2 • Zero Hunger

The Seeds of the Generous Earth

In Greenfield Valley, every spring began with a mysterious silver seed. The oldest gardener planted it beneath the hill, and by summer the valley was filled with vegetables.

But one year, the harvest was poor. The river had flooded one field, insects had damaged another, and some families had almost nothing to eat.

The children were worried.

ELYX arrived as a little light above the garden gate. "A seed becomes powerful when many hands care for it," he said.

The children asked the farmers what they needed. They learned that some fields needed compost, some needed water-saving methods, and some needed different crops that could grow in changing weather.

Instead of each family working alone, they created a shared garden.

Lena planted beans beside the corn. Sami collected fallen leaves for compost. Noor painted signs reminding everyone not to waste food. The farmers showed the children how to save seeds for the next season.

Then the children discovered a surprising problem: much of the food being grown was never eaten. Some vegetables were too small, too large, or slightly crooked for the market.

"Is an ugly carrot still a carrot?" asked Lena.

"Of course!" laughed the farmer.

So they created a Harvest Table. Extra food was shared with families, the school kitchen, and the community.

Weeks passed. The garden became greener.

At the end of summer, the silver seed had grown into a strong plant covered with tiny golden flowers.

ELYX explained that ending hunger was not only about producing more food. It was also about sharing fairly, protecting farmers, caring for soil and water, and preventing waste.

The children understood.

They had not found a magic food machine.

They had found something better: cooperation.

From then on, every harvest began with the same promise:

"Grow with care. Share with kindness. Waste nothing that can feed someone."

And the silver seed appeared again the following spring.

THINK & ACT

- Notice: What problem did the characters discover? Think: Which choice made the biggest difference? Act: What is one small thing your class or family could do?

A small question can become a big idea. A small action can become a habit.

The Garden of Glowing Hearts



SDG 3 • Good Health And Well-Being

The Garden of Glowing Hearts

Behind Sunnyhill School there was a forgotten garden. Its gate was rusty, its paths were covered with leaves, and nobody remembered when the last flower had bloomed.

Then one Monday, ELYX appeared on the classroom screen.

“Health is more than being free from illness,” he said. “It is also about feeling safe, cared for, active and connected.”

The children decided to restore the garden.

They planted herbs and flowers, built a quiet corner with cushions, and created a walking path. Every morning, the class spent ten minutes outside. Some days they stretched. Some days they listened to birds. On rainy days they talked together under the covered porch.

One child, Leo, rarely joined games. He was afraid of making mistakes.

“I don't think I am good at anything,” he whispered.

The teacher asked the children to create a Garden of Strengths.

Each child wrote one kind thing about another child. Leo received notes saying he was patient, a good listener, and brilliant at noticing tiny details.

He smiled.

Soon he began helping the younger children find insects in the garden.

One afternoon, the children found a plant with drooping leaves.

“What does it need?” asked ELYX.

“Water!” said one child.

“Sunlight!” said another.

“Maybe someone to notice it,” said Leo.

That answer stayed with them.

They realized that people can be like plants. Sometimes they need rest. Sometimes encouragement. Sometimes medical care. Sometimes a friend who simply notices that something is wrong.

The garden became a place where children could talk about feelings without shame.

At the end of the year, every child planted a glowing paper flower. On each flower was written one promise: sleep well, move every day, eat nourishing food, ask for help, listen to others, or make time for joy.

The garden did not cure every problem.

But it taught the children something important:

Taking care of yourself and taking care of others belong in the same garden.

And whenever a new child arrived at Sunnyhill School, Leo showed them the first flower.

“You can grow here,” he said.

THINK & ACT

- Notice: What problem did the characters discover? Think: Which choice made the biggest difference? Act: What is one small thing your class or family could do?

A small question can become a big idea. A small action can become a habit.

The Library of Stars



SDG 4 • Quality Education

The Library of Stars

In a town surrounded by hills stood a library with a strange ceiling. At night, the ceiling became a map of stars.

But one afternoon the librarian announced, “The Star Library is closing.”

The children were shocked.

“Why?” asked Amira.

“Not enough people use it,” said the librarian.

ELYX appeared between two shelves. “A library is not only a place for books. It is a place where questions learn to grow.”

The children decided to save it.

They created reading circles, science corners, storytelling afternoons and a small digital studio. Children who loved drawing illustrated stories. Children who loved numbers made puzzles. Children who spoke different languages shared words from home.

Amira noticed that some children could not easily reach the library after school.

So the class started a traveling library: a bright box of books that moved between homes, classrooms and community spaces.

One day, a boy named Tomas said, “I am not good at reading.”

Instead of telling him to try harder, the children asked what he liked.

“Machines.”

So they found books about bridges, robots and inventions. Tomas began reading because he wanted to discover something.

Education, the children learned, could begin with curiosity.

Soon the library was full again.

At the reopening celebration, the ceiling lit up with thousands of stars.

ELYX said, “Quality education means giving people the opportunity to learn, ask questions, develop their abilities and keep learning throughout life.”

Amira looked upward.

“How many stars are there?”

“Nobody knows,” said the librarian.

“Good,” she replied. “Then we have plenty left to discover.”

The Star Library stayed open.

And every child who entered was given a blank card.

On it were four words:

****What do you want to learn?****

Because the greatest library is the one that never runs out of questions.

THINK & ACT

- Notice: What problem did the characters discover? Think: Which choice made the biggest difference? Act: What is one small thing your class or family could do?

A small question can become a big idea. A small action can become a habit.

The Girl Who Built Bridges



SDG 5 • Gender Equality

The Girl Who Built Bridges

Maya loved building things.

She built towers from wooden blocks, bridges from cardboard and tiny houses from recycled boxes.

One day, the village announced a bridge-building competition.

Maya entered immediately.

A few children laughed.

“Bridge building is for boys,” one said.

Maya did not answer. She went to the workshop.

Her first bridge collapsed.

Her second bent in the middle.

Her third held a small stone.

ELYX appeared beside her drawing board.

“Failure is not a sign that you do not belong,” he said. “It is evidence that you are learning.”

Maya kept experimenting.

She asked her grandmother about old bridges, watched the river, measured the wind and worked with two friends, Ana and Yusuf.

On competition day, Maya presented a bridge made from bamboo, reused fabric and carefully balanced supports.

But the judges did not choose it.

Instead, they announced that the best bridge was the one built by the team that had shared ideas most fairly.

Maya's team won.

The children realized that the important question was never whether a girl or a boy had built something.

It was: Who has an idea? Who has the chance to learn? Who is encouraged to try?

The village workshop changed after that day. Tools were available to everyone. Children could choose any activity. Adults were reminded that dreams do not come with labels.

Years later, Maya became an engineer.

She returned to the village and built a real bridge over the river.

At the opening ceremony, a little girl asked, “Can girls really build bridges?”

Maya smiled.

“Girls can build bridges. Boys can build bridges. Anyone who learns, works with others and keeps trying can build bridges.”

ELYX glowed above the river.

And everyone understood that equality was not about making everyone the same.

It was about making sure everyone had the same chance to become who they could be.

THINK & ACT

- Notice: What problem did the characters discover? Think: Which choice made the biggest difference? Act: What is one small thing your class or family could do?

A small question can become a big idea. A small action can become a habit.

The Moonlit Spring



SDG 6 • Clean Water And Sanitation

The Moonlit Spring

At the foot of a mountain there was a spring called Moonwater.

People said it had once been so clear that you could see the moon in it even during the day.

But the spring had become muddy.

The village argued about who was responsible.

“The farmers!”

“The visitors!”

“The old pipes!”

While everyone argued, the children walked upstream with ELYX.

They discovered rubbish caught between rocks, soil washing down from a bare hillside and a broken pipe leaking into the stream.

“We found three problems,” said Hana. “So we need three solutions.”

The children organized a clean-up, but ELYX stopped them.

“Cleaning is useful. Preventing pollution is better.”

They worked with adults to repair the pipe, plant vegetation beside the stream and create signs explaining why waste should never enter the water.

At school, they learned about handwashing, safe toilets and the importance of keeping drinking water protected.

Months later, rain fell heavily.

The children hurried to the spring.

The water was clear.

That night, the moon appeared on its surface.

Hana whispered, “The spring remembers us.”

“No,” said ELYX. “You remembered the spring.”

The village understood that clean water is not endless magic. It needs protection, good sanitation, careful use and cooperation.

From then on, every child who visited Moonwater learned the village rule:

“Take only what you need. Keep water clean. Leave enough for tomorrow.”

And the moon kept shining in the spring.

THINK & ACT

- Notice: What problem did the characters discover? Think: Which choice made the biggest difference? Act: What is one small thing your class or family could do?

A small question can become a big idea. A small action can become a habit.

The Village That Caught the Sun



SDG 7 • Affordable And Clean Energy

The Village That Caught the Sun

Sunbeam Village had a problem: electricity was expensive, and sometimes the lights went out.

The children were annoyed because the school library became dark before they finished their homework.

Then ELYX asked them a question:

“What do you see every day that never sends a bill?”

“The sun!” shouted Karim.

The children began experimenting.

They made a small solar oven from a box and reflective material. They measured how quickly it warmed. They built a model house with windows placed to use daylight. They learned how wind could turn a small turbine.

The village adults joined them.

Soon the school installed solar panels. The community hall used efficient lights. Families learned simple ways to save energy.

One evening, the electricity failed.

Instead of becoming frightened, the children went outside.

The moon was bright.

The stars were bright.

And the solar panels were still quietly storing the day's sunshine for tomorrow.

“Energy is invisible,” said ELYX, “but our choices about it are not.”

The village council created a plan to use cleaner energy and reduce waste.

The children called the project Catch the Sun.

Years later, visitors came to see the village.

“Why did you change?” they asked.

Karim pointed to the school roof.

“Because the future should not depend only on what is easy today.”

And whenever the sun rose, the village remembered that some of the most powerful gifts arrive without making a sound.

THINK & ACT

- Notice: What problem did the characters discover? Think: Which choice made the biggest difference? Act: What is one small thing your class or family could do?

A small question can become a big idea. A small action can become a habit.

The Workshop of Golden Hands



SDG 8 • Decent Work And Economic Growth

The Workshop of Golden Hands

In Old Oak Street stood a workshop where people repaired almost everything: bicycles, shoes, clocks, toys and furniture.

Its owner, Mr. Arun, believed that every skill had value.

One day, the workshop was nearly empty. People had started throwing things away instead of repairing them.

The children asked why.

“Because people think new is always better,” Mr. Arun said.

ELYX suggested a challenge: each child would bring one broken object and learn how to repair it safely.

Mia brought a lamp. Jonas brought a wooden toy. Sara brought a bicycle bell.

The workshop became busy again.

But the children noticed something else. Some adults worked very long hours and did not have enough time with their families.

“Work should help people live,” said ELYX, “not make people invisible.”

The village began supporting local businesses that treated workers fairly, provided safe conditions and paid fairly for their work.

The workshop also started training apprentices.

Jonas became fascinated by mechanics. Mia loved design. Sara discovered she was good at organizing projects.

The children learned that a healthy economy is not simply about producing more things. It can also mean meaningful work, safe workplaces, fair opportunities, useful skills and responsible businesses.

At the end of the year, Old Oak Street held a Makers' Festival.

Every stall displayed something made, repaired or grown locally.

Mr. Arun hung a golden sign above the workshop:

****Good work builds more than products. It builds people.****

And the children knew that was a kind of wealth worth protecting.

THINK & ACT

- Notice: What problem did the characters discover? Think: Which choice made the biggest difference? Act: What is one small thing your class or family could do?

A small question can become a big idea. A small action can become a habit.

The Bridge That Learned to Fly



SDG 9 • Industry, Innovation And Infrastructure

The Bridge That Learned to Fly

A wide river divided two parts of Riverstone.

The old bridge was too narrow for everyone. Buses waited in long lines, cyclists felt unsafe, and people with wheelchairs found the steep entrance difficult.

The village needed a new bridge.

But the engineers disagreed about how to build it.

Then the school invited children to an innovation day.

ELYX appeared beside a model river.

“An invention begins with a problem,” he said. “Then someone asks a better question.”

The children built models from cardboard, sticks and recycled materials.

They tested strength with small weights.

They tested accessibility with toy wheelchairs.

They tested whether emergency vehicles could pass.

One group created a bridge that could collect rainwater.

Another added a safe cycling path.

A third designed lights powered by solar energy.

The final bridge was not the idea of one person.

It was a combination of many ideas.

When the real bridge was built, the villagers called it Skybridge because its curved shape looked like wings.

At the opening, a child asked, “Why did the bridge need so many ideas?”

ELYX answered, “Because innovation is not simply making something new. It is finding better ways to solve real problems.”

The bridge connected more than two riverbanks.

It connected engineers, workers, children, older people, cyclists, families and businesses.

And every time someone crossed it, they carried a little piece of the original question:

“How can we make this better for everyone?”

THINK & ACT

- Notice: What problem did the characters discover? Think: Which choice made the biggest difference? Act: What is one small thing your class or family could do?

A small question can become a big idea. A small action can become a habit.

The Kingdom of a Thousand Colors



SDG 10 • Reduced Inequalities

The Kingdom of a Thousand Colors

In the Kingdom of Colors, every person had a different shade of clothing.

Blue, red, green, yellow, violet and orange filled the streets.

But there was a strange rule.

People were expected to stay with others wearing the same color.

At school, the red children sat together. The green children played together. The blue children ate lunch together.

Nobody knew why.

One day, ELYX arrived and asked, "Who made this rule?"

Nobody knew.

So the children decided to test it.

They formed teams with different colors.

At first it felt strange.

Then they discovered that different groups had different strengths.

A green child was excellent at drawing maps. A red child was a fast runner. A blue child loved mathematics. A yellow child was a wonderful storyteller.

Their differences helped the team.

The children asked the adults to change the rules.

The kingdom agreed.

The new festival was called A Thousand Colors.

People brought food, music, stories and games from different backgrounds. Everyone was invited.

The king asked ELYX, "But if we celebrate differences, will we still belong to one kingdom?"

ELYX smiled.

"A rainbow does not become weaker because its colors are different."

The king understood.

From then on, the kingdom measured success not by how similar people were, but by how fairly everyone could participate.

And the streets became brighter than ever.

THINK & ACT

- Notice: What problem did the characters discover? Think: Which choice made the biggest difference? Act: What is one small thing your class or family could do?

A small question can become a big idea. A small action can become a habit.

The City That Learned to Breathe



SDG 11 • Sustainable Cities And Communities

The City That Learned to Breathe

Bellwood was a busy city.

Cars filled the streets. Buildings grew taller. Trees became harder to find.

One morning, the children noticed something unusual.

The city seemed tired.

The riverbank was crowded with rubbish. Parks were shrinking. Some streets were too noisy for birds.

ELYX appeared on a giant digital screen.

"A city is a home for people, but also for nature."

The children designed a new city map.

They added trees, safe walking paths, cycle lanes, playgrounds, accessible entrances and spaces where people could meet.

They proposed turning an empty car park into a community garden.

At first, some adults laughed.

Then the children invited them to try a small experiment.

One street became a car-free community space for one Saturday.

Families walked. Older people sat under temporary trees. Children played. Local shops stayed open.

People discovered that streets could be places to live, not only places to travel through.

The city council adopted several ideas.

Years later, Bellwood had more green spaces, cleaner public areas and better connections between neighborhoods.

One little boy asked, "Did the city become quieter?"

"Sometimes," his mother said.

"Did it become smaller?"

"No. It became more livable."

ELYX appeared above the trees.

"A sustainable city is not a perfect city," he said. "It is a city that learns how to care for the people and places inside it."

And Bellwood kept learning to breathe.

THINK & ACT

- Notice: What problem did the characters discover? Think: Which choice made the biggest difference? Act: What is one small thing your class or family could do?

A small question can become a big idea. A small action can become a habit.

The Workshop of Second Lives



SDG 12 • Responsible Consumption And Production

The Workshop of Second Lives

In Reuse Town, the children loved buying shiny new things.

But behind the school was a huge warehouse filled with objects nobody wanted anymore.

One day, ELYX opened the doors.

“Everything here has a story,” he said.

There were broken chairs, old fabrics, jars, boxes, toys and pieces of wood.

The children began a Second Lives Workshop.

They repaired toys, turned fabric into bags, made planters from containers and transformed old wood into birdhouses.

But ELYX gave them a harder challenge.

“Before you make something, ask whether you need it.”

The children learned the difference between wanting and needing.

They learned to choose durable products, share objects, repair them and recycle materials correctly.

The school cafeteria also began measuring food waste.

At first, the amount surprised everyone.

So the children created smaller portions with the option of taking more.

Waste fell.

At the end of the year, the warehouse became a community makerspace.

Its new sign read:

****USE WELL. REPAIR. SHARE. REUSE. RECYCLE.****

The children understood that responsible consumption was not about never enjoying things.

It was about thinking before taking, making products responsibly, and remembering that every object uses materials and energy.

The old warehouse was full of second lives.

And the children wondered how many more things in the world were simply waiting for someone to see their possibilities.

THINK & ACT

- Notice: What problem did the characters discover? Think: Which choice made the biggest difference? Act: What is one small thing your class or family could do?

A small question can become a big idea. A small action can become a habit.

The Dragon Who Was Too Hot



SDG 13 • Climate Action

The Dragon Who Was Too Hot

On a mountain above the clouds lived a dragon named Ember.

Ember had a problem.

He was always hot.

His cave was hot. The lake was warm. Even the snow near the mountain had begun to disappear.

"I am a dragon," he complained. "I am supposed to be hot!"

But the animals were worried.

The forest was drying. Streams were becoming smaller. Birds were changing their nesting places.

ELYX arrived carrying a little notebook.

"Climate change affects many connected parts of life," he explained.

The children of the nearby village decided to help.

They planted trees, saved water, reduced unnecessary energy use and learned how communities can prepare for extreme weather.

Ember helped too.

Instead of breathing fire whenever he was angry, he learned to breathe carefully.

He became the village's official warning dragon.

When a storm was coming, he flew over the valley and rang a giant bell.

When the forest became too dry, he helped guide people away from dangerous areas.

The dragon had not solved climate change by himself.

But he had learned that every creature could be part of the solution.

One spring, snow returned to the mountain.

Ember sat quietly beside the lake.

"Do you think the world is fixed?" he asked.

"No," said ELYX. "The work continues."

Ember nodded.

"Then I had better keep flying."

And he did.

THINK & ACT

- Notice: What problem did the characters discover? Think: Which choice made the biggest difference? Act: What is one small thing your class or family could do?

A small question can become a big idea. A small action can become a habit.

The Song of the Blue Whale



SDG 14 • Life Below Water

The Song of the Blue Whale

Far beyond the shore lived a blue whale named Luma.

Luma could sing so deeply that her song traveled through the ocean.

But one year, she noticed that her song was meeting more rubbish and fewer fish.

A young diver named Sofia heard the whale's song.

She followed it to a quiet bay where plastic floated near the rocks.

ELYX appeared inside Sofia's underwater tablet.

"The ocean connects us even when we cannot see the connection."

Sofia returned to shore and told the school.

The children organized a coastal clean-up, but they also asked a bigger question:

"Where does the rubbish come from?"

They learned about single-use plastics, waste systems, fishing equipment and the importance of protecting marine habitats.

They worked with local groups to reduce litter, sort waste and teach visitors how to protect the coast.

They also created signs saying:

****What reaches the sea can travel far.****

Months later, Sofia returned to the bay.

Luma was there.

Her song was clearer.

Sofia smiled.

The ocean had not become perfect.

But fewer pieces of rubbish floated near the shore, and more people understood their responsibility.

Luma sang again.

This time, Sofia imagined the song traveling across the sea like a message:

"The ocean is not far away.

It is part of our home."

THINK & ACT

- Notice: What problem did the characters discover? Think: Which choice made the biggest difference? Act: What is one small thing your class or family could do?

A small question can become a big idea. A small action can become a habit.

The Forest That Remembered Its Name



Nel cuore della grande foresta, gli animali e le pà

SDG 15 • Life On Land

The Forest That Remembered Its Name

The forest beside Pinehill Village had been there longer than anyone could remember.

Children called it the Whispering Forest because the leaves seemed to speak.

But each year, fewer trees stood.

A path had become a road. Some animals had disappeared. The stream was quieter.

Then ELYX asked the children to make a forest map.

They discovered that the forest was not just trees.

It was soil, insects, birds, fungi, flowers, streams, mammals and countless tiny relationships.

“We cannot protect what we do not notice,” said ELYX.

The children began noticing.

They recorded birds. They planted native trees. They protected young plants from being trampled. They created a small wildlife corridor between two green areas.

The village agreed to reduce damage to the forest and restore areas that had been degraded.

One day, the children found an old wooden sign.

It said:

****THIS FOREST HAS A NAME.****

“What is its name?” asked Nora.

The oldest villager smiled.

“Long ago, we called it Home.”

The children understood.

The forest was not simply a place humans visited.

It was home to many living things.

Years later, birds returned to the restored areas.

The stream ran more clearly.

And on quiet mornings, the children could hear the forest whisper again.

Home.

Home.

Home.

THINK & ACT

- Notice: What problem did the characters discover? Think: Which choice made the biggest difference? Act: What is one small thing your class or family could do?

A small question can become a big idea. A small action can become a habit.

The King Who Put Down His Sword



SDG 16 • Peace, Justice And Strong Institutions

The King Who Put Down His Sword

King Arvid carried a silver sword wherever he went.

He believed a strong king should always be ready to fight.

One day, two villages argued over a small piece of land.

The king reached for his sword.

ELYX appeared.

“Before you decide, have you heard both sides?”

The king stopped.

He listened.

Then he asked each village to explain what they needed.

One village needed access to water.

The other needed the land for a path.

The children suggested building a shared water channel and a public path.

Both villages agreed.

The king was surprised.

“No sword?” he asked.

“No sword,” said ELYX.

The king began to change.

He created a council where people could speak. Decisions were written down. Rules applied to everyone. People could ask questions and challenge unfair decisions.

The children learned that justice is not simply punishment.

It is fairness, rights, participation and trust.

Years later, King Arvid placed his sword in the museum.

Beside it he put a sign:

****A strong community does not need the strongest voice. It needs fair rules and people willing to listen.****

The children visited the museum often.

Whenever someone asked why the king had given up his sword, they told the story.

“He discovered that peace is not weakness.

Peace is work.”

THINK & ACT

- Notice: What problem did the characters discover? Think: Which choice made the biggest difference? Act: What is one small thing your class or family could do?

A small question can become a big idea. A small action can become a habit.

The Village of a Thousand Threads



SDG 17 • Partnerships For The Goals

The Village of a Thousand Threads

At the end of ELYX's journey stood a village called Manyhands.

Its houses were different.

Its languages were different.

Its food, songs and traditions were different.

But the village had one unfinished project: a giant tapestry showing the world they wanted to build together.

Each group had a different color of thread.

The red thread represented courage.

The blue represented water.

The green represented nature.

The golden thread represented learning.

But the villagers could not agree on how to weave them.

Then ELYX arrived.

"Perhaps the tapestry is not meant to have one pattern."

The children began listening to one another.

A teacher from one country shared a teaching idea. A farmer shared a way to reduce waste. A student showed a digital story. Another group explained how they protected a local river.

One idea led to another.

The tapestry grew.

Soon it crossed the whole village square.

The children realized something important: no single person, school, town or country could solve every global problem alone.

Partnership meant sharing knowledge, resources, creativity and responsibility.

At the center of the tapestry, they placed a simple image: two hands holding one thread.

The mayor asked, "Who made it?"

Everyone answered, "We did."

ELYX smiled.

"The thread is small," he said. "But many threads can become something strong."

When the project ended, the children carried the lesson home.

They understood that the seventeen goals were not seventeen separate roads.

They were one journey.

And everyone had a place on it.

- Notice: What problem did the characters discover? Think: Which choice made the biggest difference? Act: What is one small thing your class or family could do?

THINK & ACT

- A MESSAGE FOR TOMORROW

- Seventeen goals. Seventeen stories. One shared future.
- The Sustainable Development Goals are interconnected. The stories in this book are too. A community that reduces poverty needs education. Education supports equality. Equality strengthens peace. Clean water, healthy ecosystems, responsible production, climate action and partnerships all belong to the same larger journey.
- The most important lesson is not that children must solve the world's problems alone. It is that children can learn to notice problems, ask questions, listen to others, imagine alternatives and take part in solutions.

- Tomorrow is not a distant place. It is being built by the choices we make today.

A small question can become a big idea. A small action can become a habit.

- Educational references: United Nations, Sustainable Development Goals / 2030 Agenda; Erasmus+, European Commission.

THE FUTURE IS IN OUR HANDS

The Sustainable Development Goals are interconnected. The stories in this book are too. A community that reduces poverty can improve health. Better education can open doors. Clean water protects both people and nature. Fair work strengthens communities. Partnerships make difficult goals possible.

The most important lesson is not that children must solve the world's problems alone. It is that children can learn to notice, question, cooperate and act. Small choices can become habits; habits can become culture; and culture can shape the future.

**The future has not been written yet.
Let us give our children the chance to write
it.**



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